

Start here when you don't know which card to pull. Read from the top and take the first row that matches. Several at once? Safety comes first.

**1 I'm afraid, being threatened, or not free to say no**

*This includes jealousy that leads to checking, restricting, or accusing.*

 **Stop.** These tools are not for this. Get outside help (see Help Lines, on the back). Immediate danger: your local emergency number (999 UK/SG · 911 US · 000 AU · 112 EU).

**2 I'm flooded or shut down (but safe)**  
*Racing heart, tunnel vision, urge to flee or win*

 **Pause + Return** ·  **60-Second Alliance Reset** — Exact return time. For flooding, never for fear.

**3 Outside pressure or disapproval from family, friends or strangers**

 **Unity Anchor** — Decide together how the couple responds; never limit a partner's contact with anyone. Pressure from your partner? Green Rule, or row 1.

**4 Trust breach**  
*Lying, infidelity, a broken agreement*

 **Trust Recovery** (+  **Proof Protocol**) — Safety first. Look at the record together at the check-in.

**5 Pulling away / uninvestment**  
*Warmth missing, repairs on autopilot*

 **Uninvestment Check** (+  **Full Recovery**) — No signs: you're fine. One or two: space and small repairs. Three or more: book a Full Recovery within a week. Contempt, fear or coercion: stop and get outside support first.

**6 A fight is starting**  
*Voices rising; you're both building a case*

 **System Overlay** ·  **Conflict Protocol** — Green Rule first. Flooded midway → Pause + Return.

**7 After a fight, or something small stung**

 **Micro-Repair** — Start within minutes if you can; complete within 24 hours. If it was bigger: Full Recovery. If something needs to change: Proof Protocol.

**8 We keep clashing the same way**  
*Reach-Recoil (one reaches, the other pulls back), Repeat Ask, Pace Mismatch*

 **Circuit Library** /  **Drift Check** (+  **Profile Calibration**) — Name the loop out loud, then find it in the Circuit Library (Manual Appendix A). Clashing on timing? Manual Ch X.

**9 Intimacy feels stuck**

 **Intimacy Pact** — Pacts Worksheet. Pressure after a no → Green Rule talk; again, or can't say no → Help Lines.

**10 Saying one thing, doing another**  
*Your own follow-through*

 **Consistency Pact** (+  **Proof Protocol**) — Private weekly check. After a breach, add a shared Proof item.

**11 We feel like housemates**  
*Logistics only; the connection feels thin*

 **Morning + Evening Rhythm** — Feels like a chore? Take a night off fixing: call a Sun Memory (ideas: Sensory Comfort Inventory). Flat after two weeks? Drift Check.

**12 Time for our weekly check-in**

 **Weekly Reset** — About 40 minutes, on a timer; Weekly Reset Agenda; the monthly Care Check-in (inside the Weekly Reset).

 **At any point, if someone floods:** take a Pause + Return, then restart warm. If threats, fear, coercion or violence appear, do not return at the set time: leave safely and use the Help Lines.

Icons match the card corners. Back: Quick Reference + Help Lines.

 **Afraid of your partner, being threatened, or not free to say no?** (This includes jealousy that leads to checking, restricting, or accusing.) Stop. These tools are not for this. Get outside help: Help Lines below.

## THE THREE TO REACH FOR FIRST (ALL CORE)

 **Green Rule (Safety Gate) · CORE**  
The one rule that can't be broken: the honest thing must be safe to say. Pause the topic; if flooded but safe, Pause + Return.

*"This doesn't feel safe right now."*

 **Pause + Return · CORE**  
Time apart with a set return, for flooding (never for fear). 20 minutes minimum, 24 hours max, with an exact return time.

*"I need a pause. I'll be ready at \_\_\_\_."*

 **60-Second Alliance Reset · CORE**  
Still in the room, it's become a fight to win: stop · say it · touch (only if welcome) · three slow breaths · an exact time to keep talking.

*"I want to connect, not fight."*

## When to use which

|                                                                                     |                                                                   |                                          |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------|
|  | Flooded; need to leave and come back                              | → <b>Pause + Return</b>                  |
|  | Still in the room, tone rising, both willing to stop for a minute | → <b>60-Second Alliance Reset</b>        |
|  | Outside pressure or disapproval from family, friends or strangers | → <b>Unity Anchor</b>                    |
|  | Trust breach                                                      | → <b>Trust Recovery + Proof Protocol</b> |
|  | Pulling away                                                      | → <b>Uninvestment Check</b>              |
|  | About to say or hear something hard                               | → <b>Green Rule (Safety Gate)</b>        |
|  | Small sting or sharp tone                                         | → <b>Micro-Repair</b>                    |
|  | Anything else                                                     | → <b>the Situation Map (front)</b>       |

 **If someone floods:** take a Pause + Return, then restart warm. If threats, fear, coercion or violence appear, do not return at the set time: leave safely and use the Help Lines.

## HELP LINES

**Immediate danger:** your local emergency number (999 UK/SG · 911 US · 000 AU · 112 EU)

**US:** National Domestic Violence Hotline 1-800-799-7233 (text START to 88788) · 988 Suicide & Crisis Lifeline (call/text 988)

**UK:** National Domestic Abuse Helpline (Refuge) 0808 2000 247 · Samaritans 116 123

**Australia:** 1800RESPECT 1800 737 732 · Lifeline 13 11 14

**Singapore:** National Anti-Violence & Sexual Harassment Helpline 1800 777 0000 · SOS 1767

**LGBTQ+-affirming:** US: Trevor Project 1-866-488-7386 (under 25) · LGBT National Hotline 1-888-843-4564 · UK: Switchboard LGBT+ 0800 0119 100 · Australia: QLife 1800 184 527 · Singapore: Oogachaga (oogachaga.com)

**Elsewhere:** your local emergency number or national helpline.

**More Help Lines:** [allianceprotocols.com/help](https://allianceprotocols.com/help)